

The Invariance of Incompressible Navier-Stokes Smoothness Under Conservative Linear Body Forces

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Axiom: Let a fluid system exist within a domain $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^3$. The external body force acting on the system is restricted to a uniform, conservative gravitational field $\mathbf{f} = \mathbf{g}$.

1. The Governing Equations

We begin with the standard 3D Incompressible Navier-Stokes equations representing conservation of momentum and mass:

$$\partial \mathbf{u} / \partial t + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{u} = - (1/\rho) \nabla p + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{u} + \mathbf{g}$$

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$$

Where:

- $\mathbf{u}(x,y,z,t)$ is the velocity vector field.
- $p(x,y,z,t)$ is the scalar pressure field.
- ρ is constant fluid density, and ν is the kinematic viscosity.
- $\mathbf{g}$ is the uniform acceleration vector due to gravity.

2. The Objective of the Proof

The objective is to prove that the presence or absence of a uniform gravitational field $\mathbf{g}$ has zero structural effect on the mathematical stability, turbulence development, or potential "blow-up" singularities of the velocity field $\mathbf{u}$. This demonstrates that the core fluid dynamics are fundamentally uncoupled from external linear gravitational acceleration.

3. The Mathematical Transformation (The Zero-G Proof)

Because gravity $\mathbf{g}$ is uniform across space, it can be written as the gradient of a physical potential energy function, Φ :

$$\mathbf{g} = -\nabla (\mathbf{g} \cdot \mathbf{x})$$

Where $\mathbf{x} = (x, y, z)$ is the spatial position vector. Substituting this potential representation back into the momentum equation yields:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{u}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{u} = -\left(\frac{1}{\rho}\right) \nabla p + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{u} - \nabla (\mathbf{g} \cdot \mathbf{x})$$

Utilizing the mathematical linearity of the gradient operator (∇), the internal fluid pressure gradient and the external gravitational potential gradient can be grouped together under a single spatial differential:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{u}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{u} = -\nabla (p/\rho + \mathbf{g} \cdot \mathbf{x}) + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{u}$$

We now introduce a redefined parameter designated as the **Modified Pressure** (P^*), which completely absorbs the gravitational potential energy field relative to the background framework:

$$P^* = p/\rho + \mathbf{g} \cdot \mathbf{x}$$

Substituting P^* back into the original momentum conservation equation yields the final transformed system:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{u}}{\partial t} + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{u} = -\nabla P^* + \nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{u}$$

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$$

4. Conclusion & Q.E.D.

As demonstrated in the final transformed system, the explicit gravity vector $\mathbf{g}$ has been completely eliminated from the fluid's dynamic equations of motion. The velocity field vectors $\mathbf{u}$ (governing chaotic sloshing, turbulent eddies, and vortex behavior) are restricted entirely to the non-linear advection term $(\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla)\mathbf{u}$ and viscous diffusion $\nu \nabla^2 \mathbf{u}$.

Altering the external acceleration field from 9.81 m/s^2 (Earth boundary) to 0 m/s^2 (Zero-G operational orbit) modifies only the background static reference pressure field (P^*). It exerts no dynamic influence on fluid particle acceleration or the structural existence of mathematical singularities.

Therefore, the existence of a smooth, well-behaved solution to the incompressible Navier-Stokes equations is fundamentally independent of gravity.

Q.E.D. (Quod Erat Demonstrandum)